



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

MAY 2019

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May

Cover photo: Minnehaha's Sunrise Service on Easter Morning, April 14, 2019

SUNDAY WORSHIP SCHEDULE

9:00 AM WORSHIP WITH ORGAN AND CHOIR.

10:00 am EDUCATION & FELLOWSHIP

11:00 am WORSHIP WITH BAND AND VOCALS.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in May

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
Notes: <i>The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If your event is not on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space.</i>			1 10a Staff Meeting 5:30p Methodicals 5:30p Wed. dinners 6:15p Programming Youth & Children 6:15p Musical Reh. 6:45p Chancel Choir	2 9a Fun & Fit 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup 12p Food Shelf Board 2:30p BMM 4:30p BMM	3 10a Al-Anon 10:30a BMM 6:30p Boy Scout Crew 1 6:30p RCA	4 Therapy Dog Testing 8a BMM 3:30p Outdoor Adventure
5 Communion 9a Worship with Organ 10:15a Sunday School 11a Worship with Band 3p Youth Group 6:30p Togo 7p SAA	6 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p BMM 6:30p Boy Scouts/Den Meetings 6:30p Finance	7 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BMM 6:30p Toastmasters	8 5:30p Methodicals 5:30p Newcomer Class 5:30p Wed. dinners 6:15p Programming Youth & Children 6:15p - Musical Reh. 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	9 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit 9:30a BMM 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p BMM 4:30p BMM	10 10a Al-Anon 10:30a BMM 6:30p Boy Scout Crew 1 6:30p RCA 7p Fellowship Hall reserved 7p Taizé	11 Therapy Dog Testing 8a BMM
12 Mother's Day 9a Worship with Organ 10:15a Sunday School 11a Worship with Band 7p SAA	13 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p BMM 6:30p Boy Scouts	14 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BMM 6:30p Church Council 6:30p Nokomis Neighborhood Group	15 5:30p Methodicals 5:30p Wed. dinners 6:15p Programming Youth & Children 6:15p Musical Reh. 6:45p Chancel Choir	16 9a Fun & Fit 9:30a BMM 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup 2:30p BMM 4:30p BMM	17 10a Al-Anon 10:30a BMM 6:30p RCA	18 Armed Forces Day 8a BMM 9a Children's Sunday Rehearsal 5p Game Night
19 10a Children's Sunday Worship 3p Minnehaha Women's Group 3p Youth Group 6:30p Togo 7p SAA	20 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p BMM 6:30p Boy Scouts/Den Meetings	21 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BMM 6:30p Toastmasters 6:30p Worship Committee	22 5:30p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	23 9a Fun & Fit 9:30a BMM 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup 2:30p BMM 4:30p BMM 6:30p Trustees & B+G	24 Newsletter items due 10a Al-Anon 10:30a BMM 6:30p Boy Scout Crew 1 6:30p RCA	25 7a MinneHarvest 8a BMM
26 10a Memorial Sunday Worship 7p SAA	27 Memorial Day 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p BMM	28 9a Fun & Fit 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p BMM 6:30p SPR	29 5:30p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	30 Ascension 9a Fun & Fit 9:30a BMM 9:30a Minnehaha Playgroup 2:30p BMM 4:30p BMM 6p Mandala Graduation	31 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 10:30a BMM 6:30p Boy Scout Crew 1 6:30p RCA	Notes:

Worship in May

We are in the season of Easter! And the theme for the next several weeks is Listening to God. We'll hear some stories of the earliest figures in the Christian church and the ways they listened for God. We also have our Children's Musical on May 19 – remember that there is only one service that day at 10:00. Our one-service Sundays continue through June 2 where we recognize our graduates. Then we move to our summer schedule. See you in worship!

5th	“Listening to God: Visions and Dreams”	Acts 9:1-20
12th	“Listening to God: Called Into Life”	Acts 9:36-43
19th	Children's Musical : <i>Table for Five ...Thousand</i> One service at 10:00	
26th	“Listening to God: Contagious Action”	Acts 16:9-15 One service at 10:00

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

- ★ June 2 – Graduation Sunday, one worship service at 10:00 a.m.
- ★ June 9 – Summer worship schedule begins with 9:00 worship inside and 10:30 worship outside; all church potluck and blessing of bikes and bike helmets
- ★ June 17-21 – Music & Drama Camp
- ★ June 19-21 – Vacation Bible School
- ★ June 21 – Music & Drama Camp performance, 7pm
- ★ June 18-20 – Annual Conference gathering of United Methodist Church in St. Cloud
- ★ June 22-23 – 'Twin Cities' LGBTQ Pride Festival
- ★ June 30 – Cowboy Sunday at 10:30 service with picnic afterwards
- ★ August 4 – Worship at Minnehaha Falls at 10:30 a.m.
- ★ August 25 – Animal Blessing at 10:30 service
- ★ September 1 – One worship service at 10:00 a.m.

**Next issue is
June AND
July!**

Good Things Happen is the newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church, published each month.

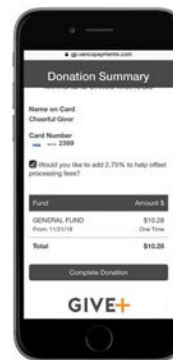
The deadline for June & July is

MAY 24

Contributions may be brought to the office or emailed to:

office@minnehaha.org
3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417

Give+ App Makes Giving Easy



Give+ is an easy way to support Minnehaha UMC. Just download the app, set up an account and you can make a one-time gift or set up regular giving in any amount you choose. Thank you!



Download it
from Apple's
App Store or
Google Play

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

Minnehaha Children, Youth, and Family Ministries

With trees budding, the grass greening, and the sunlight lasting well past dinner time, spring's arrival finally seems certain, and summer's arrival is imminent as well. Throughout the pages of this newsletter, you will see that reality reflected: in opportunities to celebrate and wrap up the 2018-2019 Program Year, as well as to prepare for all that summer has in store. It makes for a crazy time, no doubt.

In spite of that craziness (and in large part because of it), we are thankful for this Minnehaha community: for people who come together to seek, serve, and celebrate; for people from various generations building relationships and faith; for opportunities to imagine a future with hope. We celebrate all those who have helped to make our programs for Children, Youth, and Families possible, and we celebrate our children and youth, who inspire and guide us.

Jenia Strom

Interim Director of Children, Youth, & Family Ministries



Minnehaha's Children & Family Ministries:

Sundays (5th & 12th): Worship at 9 & 11am, Faith Formation at 10:15am

Wednesdays (1st, 8th, & 15th):

Dinner at 5:30pm, **Children's Programming** from 6:15 to 7:15pm

Thursdays (2nd, 9th, 16th, 23rd, & 30th): Playgroup from 9:30-11:30am, gather with children five and under and their caregivers for playtime. As weather improves, we'll be visiting local parks. Be sure you're on our mailing list and/or Facebook Group to find out where we will be each week.

Sunday, 19th: Children's Sunday

Our children will lead us in worship – one service at 10am.

Preschoolers through fifth graders will serve as greeters, ushers, and more. They'll present the musical *Table for Five...Thousand*. We'll also be thanking all of our program volunteers, celebrating the year with cake & lemonade, and planting our 2019 Minnehaha Garden.

& don't forget to sign up for Minnehaha Summer Camps - register at www.minnehaha.org

YOUTH

@ Minnehaha UMC

—

May



QUESTIONS?

Minnehaha UMC
www.minnehaha.org
 612.721.6231
education@minnehaha.org

Wednesdays, 1st May: Wednesday Night Youth Group (6th-12th Grade)
 It's dinner first from 5:30-6:15pm, then we'll be delivering May Day baskets to neighbors.

Sunday Mornings, 5th & 12th:

Worship at 9am & 11am

Sunday School at 10:15 am - 6th & 7th Graders in room 302, 8th-12th graders in room 304

Sunday Afternoon, May 5th: 3-4:30pm

Middle School Youth Group (6th & 7th Grade)

Confirmation - Mentor Night (8th & 9th Grade)

Wednesday, 8th May: Wednesday Night Youth Group (6th-12th Grade):

It's dinner first from 5:30 to 6:15pm, then Jason Emrick will guide us through some basic car maintenance.

Sunday, 12th May: Mother's Day - NO YOUTH GROUP OR CONFIRMATION

Wednesday, 15th May: Wednesday Night Youth Group (6th-12th Grade)

It's dinner first from 5:30 to 6:15pm, then we'll be planting our Salsa Garden.

Sunday, 19th May: End-of-the-Year Party for All Youth (6th-12th grade) 3-4:30pm

Wear clothes that get dirty and wet, as we'll have some games that involved water and a degree of messiness. We'll also have an ice cream bar.

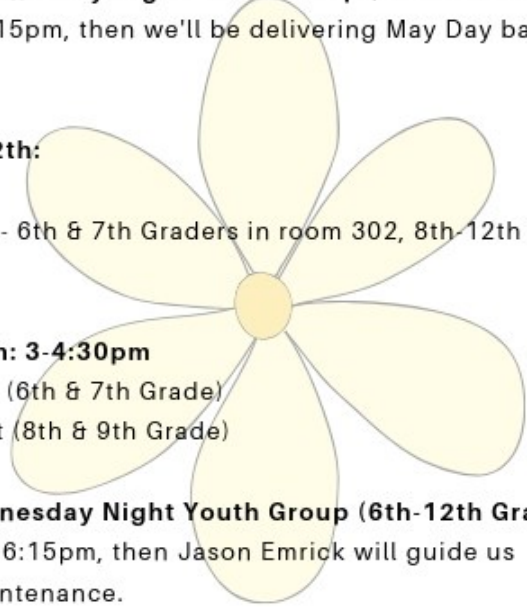
SAVE THE DATES FOR ACTIVITIES THIS SUMMER:

June 9th: Adventure to Jordan MN to visit MN's Largest Candy Store. We'll leave right after the all-church picnic - at noon, and return by 2:45pm. Throughout June & July, join us on Sunday training runs, working towards running a 5K. Those interested can join Minnehaha members at the Aquatennial Run on July 24th.

June 17-21: Music & Drama Camp & **June 19-21:** VBS - We're still looking for volunteers for VBS. Youth who've completed 7th grade can sign up to help with VBS.

July 28-31: Minnehaha Urban Bound, for those who've completed 8th-12th grade

August 15th: All Youth Activity: Serving at Feed My Starving Children from 11:30-2:30pm



THE YOUTH OF MINNEHAHA INVITE YOU TO

Urban Bound: Minnehaha Mission

SEEKING URBAN CULTURE. SERVING URBAN COMMUNITIES,
CELEBRATING DIVERSITY & NEW FRIENDSHIPS

When: July 28-31, 2019

**WHERE: MINNEHAHA
UNITED METHODIST
CHURCH, SOUTH
MINNEAPOLIS**

**WHO: YOUTH ENTERING
9TH-12TH GRADE IN 2019**

This experience is for youth who will be in high school in the 2019-2020 school year.



WHAT:

An opportunity for youth groups from out-state Minnesota to join with a small south Minneapolis youth group in doing service projects within our community, while also exploring our great city, and building friendships. Youth will stay at Minnehaha UMC, all meals will be provided.



SOME HIGHLIGHTS OF THE WEEK WILL BE:

Serving at the Minnehaha Neighborhood Food Shelf, visiting Ft. Snelling and Minnehaha Falls, exploring Minneapolis bike trails and public transportation, a visit to the Midtown Global Market and more...



Thanks to Diane and Char!

Diane Enge and Char Johnson have been coordinating our Taizé services for many, many years. They have put in countless hours of set up and clean up time, and have dedicated their energy to making sure there is a quiet place for contemplative worship each month. They are retiring from their work so they can devote their time in other ways, and May 10 will be the last Taizé service that they coordinate. Many thanks to them for the ways they have worked to keep Taizé going here at Minnehaha. And, Kristin Ammerman has agreed to be the next coordinator of Taizé! She has been shadowing Diane and Char for a couple of months, and she will pick up the mantle for our service in October.

Join us for the final Taizé of the season at 7:00 on May 10!

Newcomer Classes

We'll be holding an introduction and orientation class for anyone new to Minnehaha or interested in joining on May 8. Please join us during the Wednesday night dinner at 5:30 p.m. in the Fellowship Hall. Your meal is on us, and we'll have a table set aside for the class. If you want to stay for children & youth programming at 6:15 or choir at 6:45, we would be delighted! Just to give us an idea of numbers, please RSVP to becky@minnehaha.org. If you are interested, but cannot make the class, our next class will be Saturday morning, September 28.

One Service Sundays

We will be having one service at 10:00 for these three weeks:

- May 19 – one service inside at 10:00 for the Children's Musical & to celebrate the end of the program/school year
- May 26 – one service inside at 10:00. Memorial Day weekend. We'll also try to have our annual practice fire drill following the service
- June 2 – one service inside at 10:00 to celebrate our graduating seniors with a special coffee hour in their honor following the service

Our summer schedule of 9:00 indoors and 10:30 outdoors will begin on Sunday, June 9 with a blessing of bikes and bike helmets and a potluck picnic outside following worship.



WHAT IS REQUIRED/THE COST FOR YOU?

Youth groups are responsible for providing transportation to and from Minnehaha as well as providing 1 adult for every 6 youth. Cost: \$75/youth. No charge for chaperones. Bring your own bedding.

INTERESTED?

**WE HAVE LIMITED SPACE SO CONTACT US AS SOON
AS POSSIBLE WITH QUESTIONS AND/OR TO REGISTER**

Minnehaha United Methodist Church
3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis MN 55417
www.minnehaha.org
612.721.6231 education@minnehaha.org

Giving Up Plastics for Easter

As we practice living the resurrection, don't forget our relationship with creation. Take the plastics challenge for the seven weeks of Easter. And, these are cumulative, so add a new practice each week. By the time we reach the end of the Easter season, you may find yourself practicing resurrection in a more whole, environmentally sensitive way.

Week 1 (April 21-27): Bring your own reusable bags when you shop. Plastic bags and produce bags in particular are often used for minutes before being discarded. Most plastic bags are not recycled, ending up in landfills.

Week 2 (April 28 – May 4): Give up disposable cups and drinks in plastic bottles. Carry a travel mug or water bottle. Get a reusable bottle, fill it up with tap water before leaving the house, and refill it wherever you happen to be.

Week 3 (May 5-11) Carry your own non-plastic cutlery. Plastic disposable cutlery and straws are among the worst plastic pollution culprits. Get in the habit of carrying your own cutlery with you and leaving a set in the car. For all those potlucks and picnics coming up this summer, you can have an entire picnic set that you use, wash, and then use again. Metal straws can be purchased at many stores, including hardware stores.

Week 4 (May 12-18): Buy in bulk to minimize or eliminate packaging. This goes for food and drink as well as cleaning supplies, toiletries, hardware items – anything that may come in plastic packaging.

Week 5 (May 19-25): Use non-plastic containers for food– lunches, leftovers, freezing, storage, take-out, travelling, etc. Request takeaways use your container instead of their disposable one. Take a container when you buy meat, fish or cheese.

Week 6 (May 26 – June 1): Use a razor with removable blades. Disposable razors and razor blades are two of the biggest contributors to plastic waste.

Week 7 (June 2-8): Use bar soap instead of liquid hand soap. This is an easy change to make, if you are feeling keen you can even make your own soap bars.

Faith Forum May 5: Ramadan and Fasting with our Muslim Friends

This is the fifth in our five-week series on Islam. Ramadan begins tonight for Muslims. What is Ramadan and why is it important? What do Muslims do during Ramadan? This week, we will be joined by our Muslim friends who will teach us about Ramadan. We have been asked by our Muslim friends to fast for 5 days during Ramadan to show our solidarity with them in faith and life, so if you would like to fast with us, come and learn how! Hint: did you know that fasting is a Christian thing too?

Facilitated by Matthew Palombo, PhD in the Study of Islam from the University of Johannesburg, South Africa. Faculty in Philosophy and Religion at Minneapolis College.



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9:30-11:30am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month (on the fourth Saturday of the month) is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. Please join us this month on Saturday, May 25. You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the trucks starting at 7, serve the food at 9:00, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, and bring a friend! Given that this is Memorial Day weekend, we could use some extra volunteers since some of our regulars will be out of town.

ON SUNDAY, 19TH MAY
WE HAVE JUST ONE SERVICE AT 10AM

Join us for worship as we:
Celebrate the Program Year
Recognize & Thank Our Program Volunteers
Plant our 2019 Minnehaha Garden
and

The Children of Minnehaha present

Table for Five...Thousand

THE MIRACLE OF LOAVES AND FISHES

www.minnehaha.org

MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH

We are looking for graduates!

**Are you or someone in your family graduating from
high school, college, or grad school in 2019?**

**WE'LL BE RECOGNIZING OUR 2019 GRADUATES
ON SUNDAY, JUNE 2ND AT BOTH WORSHIP
SERVICES (9AM AND 11AM).**

Please contact the church office (612.721.6231) or
education@minnehaha.org and let us know names, schools, and
other pertinent information so we can celebrate you/your graduate!



Monthly Communion at Nokomis Square

A brief service of communion is offered at Nokomis Square on the second Thursday of this month. All are welcome to join us on May 9 at 1:00 p.m.

SAVE THE DATE: Will Party – Saturday, June 8 @ 9:00 am

On Saturday, June 8, starting at 9:00 am with a continental breakfast, Minnehaha UMC will host a “Will Party” event. All are invited to attend, young and old.

This “Will Party” will provide an opportunity for those who wish to start or revise a will to meet with an attorney. Steve Otto of Otto Law (www.ottoesq.com), a Twin Cities law firm focusing on estate planning/probate administration and business law, will be at the meeting to talk about wills, answer your questions, and to meet one-on-one to discuss your estate planning needs. (There is no charge for this initial consultation.) If you would like to have a will drawn up or do other estate planning, you can set up a follow-up meeting.

Childcare will also be provided upon request. RSVP's not necessary but appreciated so we know about how many will be attending. Questions regarding this event and RSVP's may be directed to Kim Kanuit at kanuitkk@q.com or call/text 612-860-0256. Thank you.

We're All In!

On Palm Sunday, we made a commitment to stay together as a congregation and walk into an inclusive future together. If you didn't get a chance to sign the banner, we still have it available. Just let Becky or Jenia know that you want to sign it and we'll pull it out of Becky's office for you. Here are some important things to know:

The Traditional Plan, passed at General Conference in St. Louis in February of 2019, would substantially change the way Minnehaha, and many other congregations, relate to our denomination and do ministry in our community. **HOWEVER,**

The vast majority of the Traditional Plan will likely be found unconstitutional by our Judicial Council, which meets April 23-27 (this meeting will take place after our newsletter deadline, so check in for updates).

The parts of the Traditional Plan which might pass constitutional inquiry take our current laws and make them more stringent. If found constitutional, those more stringent rules go into effect January 1, 2020.

As a Reconciling Congregation, we already stand in opposition to those rules.

There are plans underway to bring legislation to our next General Conference (May 2020) that would dissolve the United Methodist Church as a denomination, allowing at least 2 different successor denominations to form in its place. The assets would be divided between these 2 groups, and congregations would be allowed to choose which way they want to go, taking their buildings and assets with them.

The United Methodist Church is created as a connectional denomination. Written into our foundational documents are things which tie us tightly to one another. Undoing these close connections will take time and a lot of legal expertise. Therefore, even if we vote in May of 2020 to split, there will be a period of time (probably 2-3 years) given in which to carry this out.

Maintaining our vitality as we walk this road is important. It is important to the work we do in our community, and it is important for our future. That is why we want to state now, and to hold in front of ourselves, our commitment to continue to be Minnehaha, even if we end up being something other than United Methodist in the years to come.



Summer at Minnehaha

SUNDAY MORNING SUMMER SCHEDULE

Worship at 9am - inside with organ & choir
Worship at 10:30 am - Outside with band
Faith Formation is on Summer Vacation

SPECIAL SUNDAYS

Yes, every Sunday is special, but mark your calendars for these particular Sundays:

June 9th: Pentecost

We kick-off our summer schedule, and celebrate and bid adieu to our interim choir director, A.P. Hopper; bless our bikes and helmets, and have an all-church potluck picnic following the 10:30 service.

June 30th: Cowboy Sunday

Join us at the 10:30 worship service for our fourth annual Cowboy Sunday, stick around afterwards for an all-church picnic.

August 4th

No service at Minnehaha, join us for worship at Minnehaha Falls at 10:30am.

August 25th

Blessing of the Animals. Bring your pets with you to the 10:30 service for a blessing.

September 1st

Labor Day - One service at 10am

September 8th: Rally Day!

Kick-off the 2019-2020 program year with one service at 10am, followed by an all-church picnic

We look forward to a wonderful summer at Minnehaha & hope you can join us.

www.minnehaha.org
3701 E. 50th Street
Minneapolis MN 55417
612.721.6231



THE TALES OF ROALD DAHL

MUSIC & DRAMA CAMP 2019

MONDAY, JUNE 17 - FRIDAY, JUNE 21ST
FROM 9AM-3PM

PERFORMANCE FRIDAY, JUNE 21ST AT 7PM

Who: Kids/youth are entering 3rd-8th grade

Join us for a wonderful week. Together, under the direction of local actor, director, and teacher Maureen Trepp, we'll take on all aspects of creating a musical production featuring tales by Roald Dahl.

Register today at Minnehaha UMC or by visiting
www.minnehaha.org



HEAD TO CAMP KORONIS WITH US!

Camp Minnesota, a division of the the UMC Minnesota Annual Conference, puts on some great camps and we love to attend together.

THIS YEAR, WE'RE LOOKING AT:

TEDDY BEAR CAMP (FOR 6-9 YEAR OLDS)
SESSION 2 - FROM JULY 11-13

&

TRAILBLAZERS CAMP (FOR 8-12 YEAR OLDS)
SESSION 2 - FROM JULY 7-10

&

PATHWAYS CAMP (FOR 9-13 YEAR OLDS)
SESSION 2 - FROM JUNE 23-28

REGISTRATION IS OPEN & SPOTS FILL QUICKLY! SIGN UP TODAY AT
WWW.CAMPMINNESOTA.ORG



Minnehaha UMC's Vacation Bible School 2019

When: Wednesday, June 19th - Friday, June 21st
from 9-11:30am Extended Childcare Available

Who: Children who are 3 (and potty-trained) - 10 years old

Where: Minnehaha United Methodist Church
Cost: \$25/child or \$45/family

Register today at Minnehaha UMC or online at
www.minnehaha.org.

Explore where God's power can take you!
At Minnehaha, we'll spend these three mornings connecting with old friends and new. This space adventure includes amazing science, creative crafts, fun recreation, exciting music, and memorable Bible stories that will help experience God's amazing power.

Glory to God, who is able to do far beyond all that
we could ask or imagine by God's power at work within us
-Ephesians 3:20

Have a Blessed Ramadan

Once again this year, the Minnesota Council of Churches is providing signs for Christian and Jewish congregations to put in their lawns wishing our Muslim brothers and sister a blessed Ramadan. Once again this year, we will be putting the sign in our lawn. It's a neighborly thing to do, and given our partnership with the Daud family, we have some extra connections to the practice.

Ramadan is one of the largest Islamic observances. It is a 30-day period which moves around the calendar (this year, it starts at sundown on May 5). It celebrates the first revelation of the Quran to the prophet Mohammad. Ramadan is observed as a time of fasting from all food and drink from sunrise to sunset, and observing Ramadan is one of the five pillars of Islam. Many Muslims time a pilgrimage to Mecca (another of the five pillars) during Ramadan. The observance of Ramadan ends with the celebratory holiday of Eid al-Fitr.

We'll have our sign up for all of Ramadan this year - when you see it, or others like it in your neighborhood - remember to hold our Muslim brothers and sisters, especially the Dauds, in prayer.

Note
from the
pastor



Spring Migration

I am a very amateur birder, so my knowledge on the subject is not very extensive, but I love watching the birds this time of year. While the leaves are still off the trees, I can see better all the little songbirds that are either back in town, passing through, or just out enjoying the warmer weather and the new food it brings. I love seeing the robins that wintered through (there's a whole flock that lived in the trees on the parkway near my house), the cardinals that were such a great contrast to the winter white and gray, and the large pileated woodpeckers. I also love those that have come back for the summer – the red-wing blackbirds and house sparrows and bald eagles and mallard ducks. And then there are the ones just passing through – the loons that will end up settling further north, the yellow-rumped warblers, the buffleheads. It doesn't matter whether the birds have been here all year, are coming for the summer, or are just here for a few weeks, they are all busy. Whatever time they have in my area, they are foraging for food, finding a place to sleep, interacting with other birds and predators. Maybe it's a sign for us as well. No matter if we are settled in place for life, for a season, or just passing through, God still beckons to us. The Bible is full of stories of people who stay and people who pass through, but in all of them, those people are making community and paying attention to God (or studiously ignoring God until they can't anymore) wherever they are. God doesn't wait for us to get "settled" to beckon to us. God beckons to us at every place and time in our lives. Whether we are trying to balance careers and children and aging parents or are retired. Whether we job-hunting or empty-nesters. Whether we are renting or buying. Whether we like our current neighbors or don't. God calls us to be part of whatever community we are in at this moment in our lives. Whoever we encounter is our neighbor. Whatever our end goal, where we are is where we are. Whether you wintered over, are back for the summer, or are just migrating through, listen to what God is beckoning you to do and be.



In Joy,
Becky



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Minneapolis, MN 55417

Address Service Requested

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E-Mail: becky@minnehaha.org
office@minnehaha.org
5/19



Minnehaha Snapshot: First Quarter 2019



The vote at the 2019 Special Session of the Annual Conference in St. Louis was a blow to Minnehaha. But we continue to welcome everyone and to celebrate. In the first quarter of the year we enjoyed scores of great programs for children, youth, adults, and families. Our congregation continues to give generously. And our faith is strong. That's something to be thankful for.

268 CELEBRATED INCLUSION



On March 3, 268 celebrated at Minnehaha's two Sunday worship services. Minnehaha proudly welcomes everybody, including the LGBTQ+ community.

10 SERVED FOOD AT SIMPSON SHELTER



On March 6, ten volunteers from Minnehaha served more than 100 clients of Simpson Shelter. We'll also serve meals in April and June. Volunteer to help!

60 ATTENDED THE WINTER RETREAT



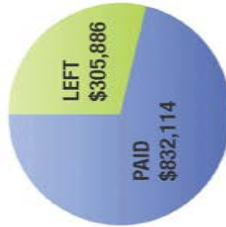
The weekend of January 25-27 was cold, but that didn't keep the 60 attendees from skis, games, worship, reading and square dancing.

100 PERCENT PAID IN FULL



All bills, mortgage and apportionment payments were paid through March 2019. Note: Starting in January, Minnehaha designated that all apportionments stay with the Minnesota Conference.

73 PERCENT PAID OFF



So far we've paid off 73% of our 2010 building and remodeling project.

31 CHILDREN AND ADULTS AT FAMILY BOOK CLUB



On March 2, thirty-one kids and adults had conversations and activities based on the classic "Charlotte's Web" by E.B. White. Younger readers enjoyed "The Big Red Barn" by Margaret Wise Brown.

6 YOUTH BUILT WOODEN BIRDHOUSES



In February, Minnehaha's youth learned how to safely use power tools and then built birdhouses using those skills.

16 ADULTS TOPPED TATERS



On March 16, sixteen adults attended the second annual Top the Tater potluck party at Becketwood. There was a pot o' gold (Yukon Golds) at the end of the table.

3 PERFORMANCES OF MINNEHAHA MUSICAL



In February, the Minnehaha Players (directed by Maureen Trepp) presented "Haphazardly Ever After," a crazy comedy that relied on the talents of more than 46 performers and crew, ages six and up.